



BEFORE

While Missouri had helped inflame the sectional tensions that led to the war, the state of Kentucky had been a source of moderation and compromise.

CLAY THE COMPROMISER

Kentucky produced the greatest prewar compromiser, **Senator Henry Clay**, while Senator John J. Crittenden from the same state tried to broker another compromise in 1861. If Clay had won the presidency in 1844 he would have rejected the annexation of Texas and **probably prevented the War with Mexico**. Without the problem over slavery in the new territories (see [Splits emerge](#)), the Civil War might well have been averted.

MISSOURI AND "BLEEDING KANSAS"



AID COMPANY SIGN FOR NEW ENGLANDERS

Not only had Missouri been the **center of the controversy over slavery** that led to the Missouri Compromise of 1820, pro-slavery settlers there had caused much sectional violence in the 1850s across the border in "[Bleeding Kansas](#)", where they clashed with Free-Soilers—some of whom had emigrated from New England. During the Civil War, Free-Soil Kansans served in Missouri, and Missouri guerrillas engaged in cross-border raids.

Missouri was no stranger to sectional violence. The state's role in the problems of "Bleeding Kansas" across the border in the 1850s, where its pro-slavery settlers battled Free-Soilers, had become a prologue to the Civil War. Nevertheless, Union sentiment in the territory had great strength, and nearly three-quarters of the white Missourians who served as Civil War soldiers fought for the Union.